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CONSULTING
— PURDUE —



United Way – Read to Succeed

Scaling our impact by growing the hands that make it happen.



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Agenda

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- 4) Market Research
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Executive Summary

Call to Action: United Way should move forward with the Coordinator hire and initiate Purdue partnership outreach before the next volunteer cycle begins.

Problem Statement

- Post-COVID volunteer decrease
- Weak visibility among student audience
- Scattered communication
- No centralized volunteer database



Market Opportunity

- 75M+ new volunteers
- Gen Z wants meaningful roles
- Purdue new pool



Our Solution



Outreach to Purdue clubs



Student-tailored marketing



Volunteer Coordinator toolkit



Centralized volunteer comm hub

Impact

- Grow from ~250 to 325+
- Reduce comm breakdowns
- Improve volunteer retention
- Long-term program expansion



Implementation Roadmap

- **Short-Term:** Launch campus outreach, Coordinator role, toolkit, and pilot communication hub.
- **Long-Term:** Build formal campus partnerships, scale the hub, and automate tracking.

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Marketing: Problem & Goal

Read to Succeed needs stronger outreach and simpler engagement to grow and retain more volunteers.

CURRENT GAPS

- Post covid volunteer numbers have not fully recovered; outreach is inconsistent
- Lack of unified marketing channels → unclear volunteer sign-up communication
- Fragmented databases → difficult to re-engage past volunteers
- Weak visibility into volunteer progress due to no centralized tracking system

OUR GOAL

- Grow total number of active volunteers from **250 to 325+**
- Launch a **centralized marketing strategy** with modern digital campaigns (**Teach One Hour**)
- Strengthen **volunteer retention**
- Build a **centralized volunteer database** →
- re-engagement, tracking, and reporting



Volunteer Communication: Current Gaps & Goal

Identifying breakdowns in volunteer communication and establishing a unified process.



CURRENT GAPS

- Information is scattered → higher error risk
- Communication channel is inconsistent and causes delays
- Volunteers lack a centralized place to view openings or request swaps



OUR GOAL

Create a clear, repeatable communication process that ensures:

- Every session is properly staffed
- Volunteers always know what is happening

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Market Research

Market Insights

- Volunteer participation is rebounding post-COVID, with 75.7M Americans engaged in 2023
- Younger volunteers seek flexible, meaningful, impact-driven opportunities

Key Trends

- Reach younger audiences by emphasizing flexibility and clear impact
- Rise of virtual, micro, and skills-based volunteering



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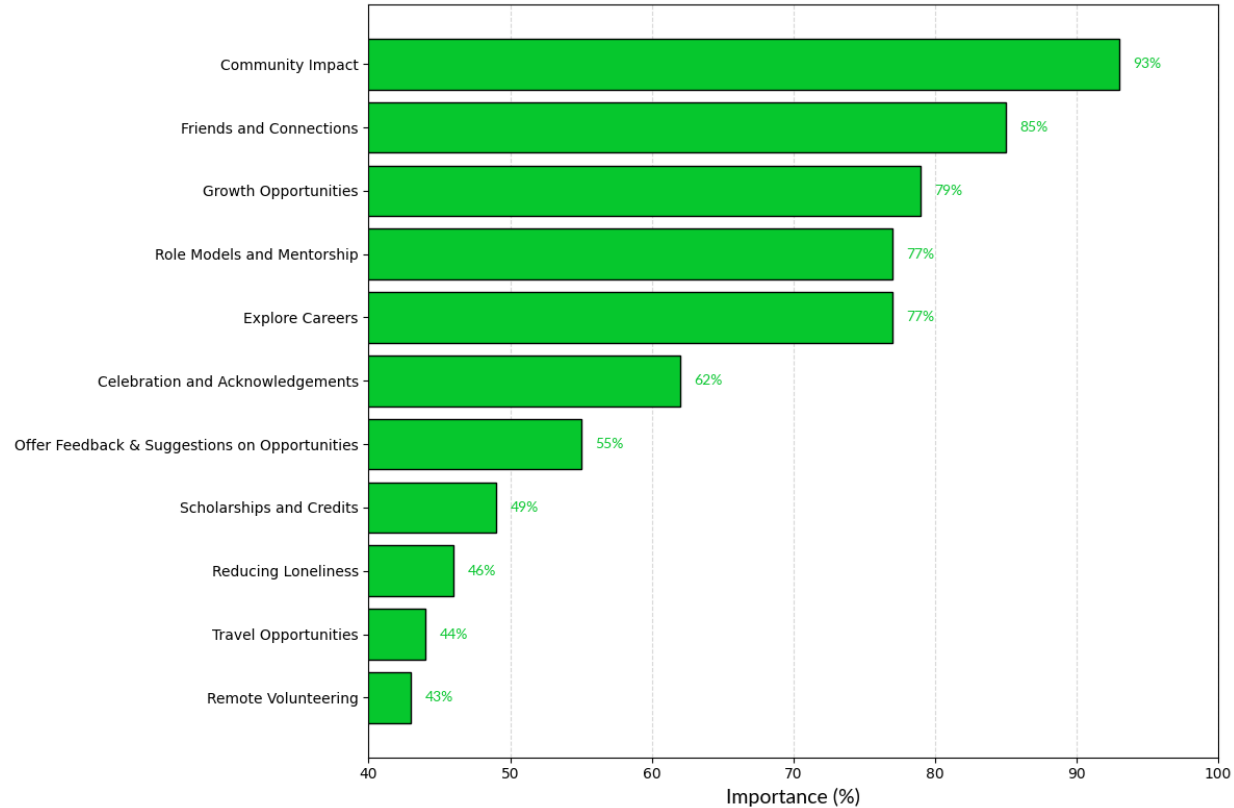
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Importance of Volunteer factors



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Solution 1: Targeted Outreach and Recruitment



Campus Awareness

- Purdue Student Government (PSG)
- Residence Hall Life → high visibility for first-year and on-campus students.
- Purdue students already participate in service programs (e.g., College Mentors for Kids)

Sororities, Fraternities & Cooperative Life

- Built-in philanthropy culture and high volunteer engagement.
- United Way offers a ready cause for chapters seeking impact
- Example: Alpha Xi Delta donates 75,000+ service hours to children's causes

Academic Colleges at Purdue

- The College of Education
- The College of Liberal Arts: (i.e. English Majors)
- The John Martinson Honors College partners with Heads Up Tutoring & Life Skills



Solution 2: Tailored Marketing Material



Updates News Events



Volunteer Now
MAKING A DIFFERENCE ONE PAGE AT A TIME

About Read to Succeed

- Seeks to bolster the support available to young readers in their early literacy journey. Read to Succeed places volunteers in K-5 classrooms across Tippecanoe County every year. Volunteers match with a local teacher and join their classroom for at least one hour a week for the duration of the academic year.



Volunteer Spotlight



Meet Jordan Ellis

I had the opportunity of volunteering for United Way's Teach One Hour program where I got to spend time with incredible kids who were eager to learn as much as possible.

Her motto: "It's about creating experiences, not just messages."



TEACH ONE HOUR
CHANGE ONE LIFE!
Helping kids build confidence and literacy



YOUR COMMITMENT

- ✓ Only 1 hour per week
- ✓ Training and support provided
- ✓ Flexible scheduling
- ✓ In-person and virtual options available

WHY VOLUNTEER?

- ✓ Make a measurable difference in a child's education
- ✓ See students' reading skills grow
- ✓ Build meaningful relationships
- ✓ Gain classroom and leadership experience
- ✓ Great for education majors, Greek life, and service goals

Contact Us Today:

- ☎ 765.742.9077
- ✉ teach@unitedway.org
- 🌐 <https://unitedwayteche.org/readtosucceed/>



Scan me!

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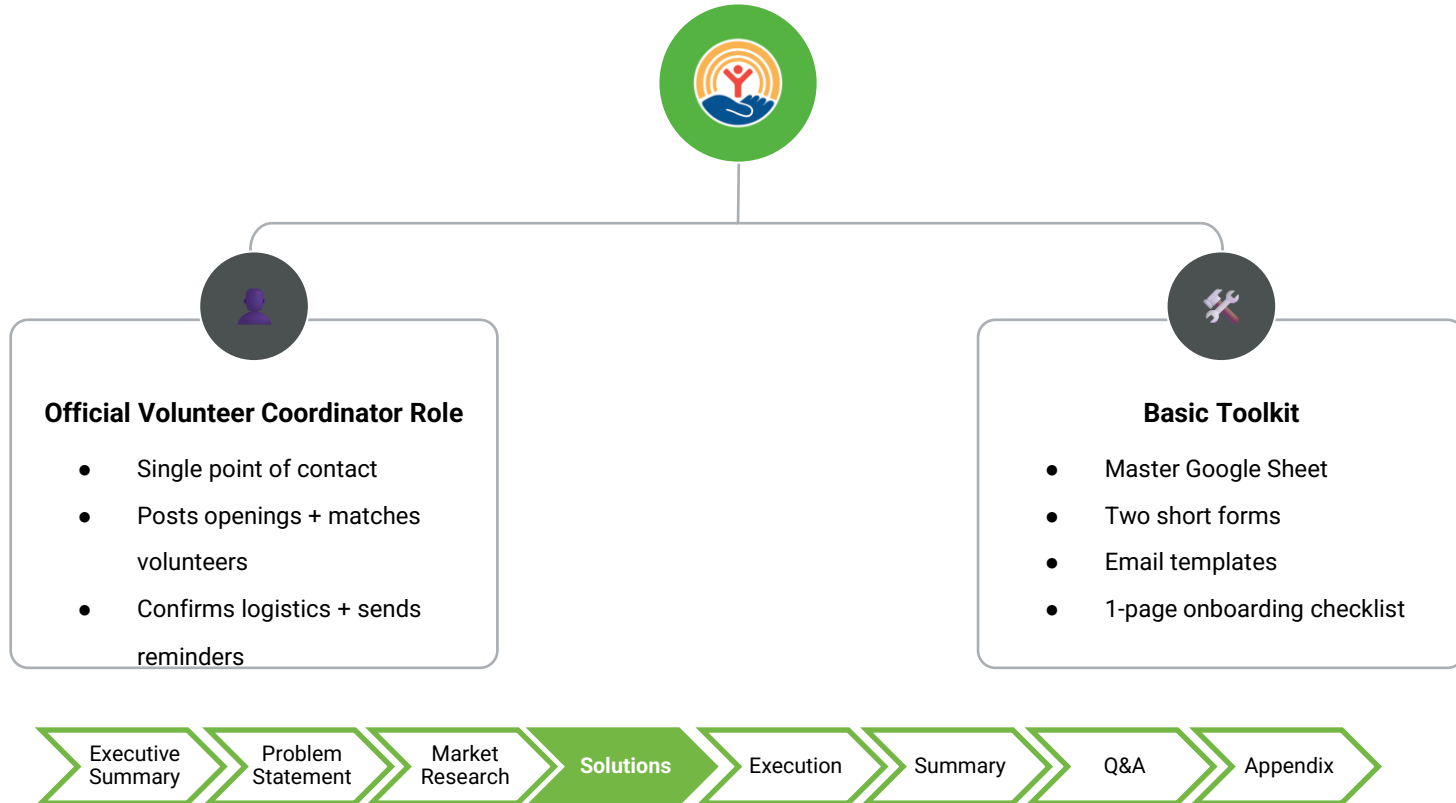
Execution

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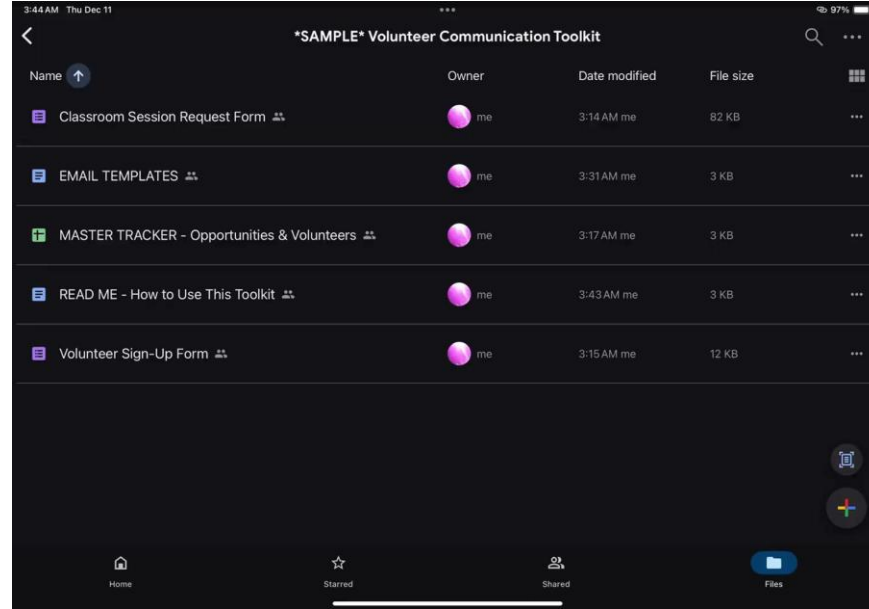
Q&A

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Solution 3: Coordinator + Simple Tools



Examples (Using Google Drive):



The screenshot shows a mobile interface of a Google Drive folder named '*SAMPLE* Volunteer Communication Toolkit'. The folder contains six files, all owned by 'me'. The files are listed in a table with columns for Name, Owner, Date modified, and File size. The files are: Classroom Session Request Form (82 KB), EMAIL TEMPLATES (3 KB), MASTER TRACKER - Opportunities & Volunteers (3 KB), READ ME - How to Use This Toolkit (3 KB), and Volunteer Sign-Up Form (12 KB). The bottom navigation bar shows icons for Home, Starred, Shared, and Files.

Name	Owner	Date modified	File size
Classroom Session Request Form	me	3:14 AM me	82 KB
EMAIL TEMPLATES	me	3:31 AM me	3 KB
MASTER TRACKER - Opportunities & Volunteers	me	3:17 AM me	3 KB
READ ME - How to Use This Toolkit	me	3:43 AM me	3 KB
Volunteer Sign-Up Form	me	3:15 AM me	12 KB

[*SAMPLE* Toolkit Google Drive](#)



Solution 4: Volunteer Community Hub

 What it is	 How to set it up	 Why it helps
• One shared group chat for all volunteers, the coordinator, and 1 UW staff • Platform can be Discord • Used for openings, swaps, and quick updates	• Create a server (ex: "UW Volunteers – [City]") • Post a pinned welcome message with: ○ Sign-up link ○ Group norms ○ How to swap or cover a session	• Faster coverage when someone cancels • Less 1:1 email back-and-forth • Volunteers feel like a community, not individual helpers



Execution Timeline Aligned to Academic Cycles

Jan–Feb 2026 | Internal Readiness

- Coordinator onboarding
- Toolkit + Volunteer Hub setup
- Update marketing materials

May–Jul 2026 | Summer Prep (Digital Only)

- Light touchpoints with early-interest students
- Finalize August activation schedule
- Confirm fall partnerships and tabling slots

Oct–Mar 2026/2027 | Retention & Engagement

- Impact updates
- Volunteer community Hub activation
- Swap management

Mar–Apr 2026 | Early Recruitment Window

- Outreach to departments, Greek Life, Honors
- “Teach One Hour – Fall Priority Sign-Up”
- Collect early commitments for Fall
- Secure course-credit partnerships

Aug–Sep 2026 | Peak Recruitment

- Welcome Week tabling
- Classroom announcements
- Greek Life presentations
- Launch scheduling + onboarding



Summary

The Challenge:

- Expand Volunteer base
- Increase marketing + improve processes

Our Research:

- Volunteering rising again, especially in younger generations

Our Findings:

- Limited market reach
- Could improve communication channels

Solutions:

- 1) **Targeted Outreach** to Purdue,
- 2) **Clean, tailored marketing materials**
- 3) **A dedicated Volunteer Coordinator**
- 4) **A Volunteer Community Hub**



Questions and Answers



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Appendix

List of Purdue Contacts:

- Abby Howard: Associate Director for Fraternity, Sorority & Cooperative Life : howardal@purdue.edu
- Laura Green: Panhellenic Association: Director of Community Engagement. Promotes philanthropy and community service events across campus: engagement@purduephc.com
- Joshua MacKinnon: Inter Fraternity council: Director of Philanthropy & Community Service. philanthropy@purdueifc.com
- Multicultural Greek Council Chapters: Contains info for each individual group <https://www.purdue.edu/fscl/councils/mgc/chapters.php>
- Kristy Foster: College of Liberal Arts: Director of College Outreach. knfoster@purdue.edu
- Office of graduate studies (College of Education): They pass it on to whichever department the program would best serve. edgrad@purdue.edu
- Doctor Sunnie Watson: Assistant dean for Engagement and Global Initiatives watson82@purdue.edu
- Purdue Student Government: Aisha Moton: Director. motona@purdue.edu
- [Targeted Outreach: Slide 9](#)



Appendix

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